

AI Sandbox Personas

1 The Constrained Corporate Change Agent

Core Context

Works inside enterprise constraints. High compliance, limited tool access (often Copilot-only), risk-averse culture.

Emotional JTBD

"Help me feel in control and safe while navigating AI in a highly regulated environment."

They want to feel:

- In charge of outputs (not blindly trusting AI)
- Protected from reputational or compliance harm
- Calm in front of ambiguity

They do manual validation rituals not because they love it — but because it restores their emotional safety.

Social JTBD

"Help me be seen as a credible, responsible, strategic professional — not an AI cowboy."

They want to be perceived as:

- Serious and thoughtful
- Governance-aware
- Strategic in stakeholder rooms
- Modern — but not reckless

They care deeply about avoiding "AI-for-AI's-sake" optics.

SUE Forces

Pains

- Red tape / unclear allowed use

Gains

- Faster analysis
- Stakeholder-ready narratives
- Structured thinking support

Comforts

- Manual review processes
- Established governance routines
- AI first mindset vs human first ("we need to do something with AI" without objectives)

Anxieties

- Compliance violations
- Bias in assessments
- Loss of professional credibility

What This Persona Needs from the AI Sandbox

The sandbox must:

- Include compliance-safe workflows
 - Provide bias-check & validation templates
 - Offer "Copilot-only" tracks
 - Equip them with slides/templates to justify AI use internally
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The Authentic Craft Professional

Core Context

Strong professional identity. Values nuance, language, authenticity. Concerned about losing voice or becoming dependent.

Emotional JTBD

"Help me stay authentic and human while becoming more efficient and effective."

They want to feel:

- Proud of their output
- Like the work still reflects them
- Not over-reliant

When AI output feels generic or depersonalized, it triggers discomfort.

Social JTBD

"Help me be seen as a thoughtful, human-centered L&D professional — not a prompt jockey."

They want:

- Respect for craftsmanship
- Recognition for nuance
- Not to look lazy or automated

They resist hype culture strongly.

SUE Forces

Pains

- Time pressure
- Repetitive drafting work

Gains

- Idea expansion
- Structure support
- Language polishing

Comforts

- Personal writing process
- Creative ownership

Anxieties

- Loss of voice

- Cognitive dependency
- Generic, shallow outputs

🔑 What This Persona Needs from the AI Sandbox

The sandbox must:

- Teach voice-preserving prompting
- Include "AI as critic, not creator" workflows
- Build in reflection steps ("What's mine vs AI?")
- Normalize controlled use (avoid over-reliance)

If it becomes tool-showcase-driven, they disengage.

3 The Stranded Pioneer

Built from qualitative research interviews with corporate L&D consultants.

Core Context

Personally ahead of their organisation. Already using AI daily — some have built complex automated workflows (chatbots, API integrations, automated reporting pipelines). But working in isolation: no peer to challenge their thinking, no organisational permission to scale what they've built personally, often constrained to Copilot at work while experimenting freely on a personal laptop. The researcher note on this profile: *"This is an identity problem."* They still define themselves as content creators. The shift to workflow designer hasn't happened yet — not because they lack capability, but because no one has given them the frame, the peer group, or the permission.

🎯 Emotional JTBD

"Help me make the leap from personal AI tinkerer to someone who has actually redesigned how the work gets done — without losing my credibility or my organisation in the process."

They want to feel:

- Ahead, not behind — they've invested significant personal time and they need it to be building toward something
- Like a pioneer with peers, not a renegade working alone
- In control of an increasingly complex personal AI practice that is starting to feel like an echo chamber
- That the identity shift — from content producer to strategic partner — is possible and has a path

They have a quiet anxiety about dependency: *"Het is ook wel een soort verslaving... dat je denkt zal ik eerst hem zijn vragen"* (It's a kind of addiction — always asking AI first). They're not sure where the line is.

👥 Social JTBD

"Help me be seen as a strategic partner — not just a more efficient content producer."

They want to be perceived as:

- Someone who redesigns systems, not just someone who makes slides faster
- Trustworthy to their organisation — not a renegade working around restrictions on a personal laptop
- Technically credible without being a developer: *"I'm not a coder or a developer... but I'm using systems that I never thought I'd use before"*

- Worth listening to in a stakeholder room — *"their respect for L&D goes up a bit, or at least respect for me goes up a bit"*

They are acutely aware that L&D faces an existential threat: *"I think that L and D is one of the biggest risks industries for AI... The train has already left the station."* This sharpens the urgency. They need to become the strategic partner before the role disappears.

SUE Forces

Pains

- Working in organisational isolation — the "echo chamber" problem: no peer at the same level to challenge thinking or validate direction
- Red tape blocking what they've already proven works personally (Copilot-only restrictions while experimenting on personal laptop)
- Unclear budget and approval processes for experimentation — *"I'm curious but I don't have the time, space and tools to experiment"*
- Leadership resistance to moving beyond basic AI training — *"I don't want to pirate. I want to understand what I can do within constraints"*
- Content creation with AI disappoints: *"result was superficial 'fluff' with basic slogans and exercises"* — they've hit the ceiling of task-level AI use
- AI "goes down a rabbit hole" — frustrating iteration cycles after significant time investment

Gains

- Strategic partner status in stakeholder rooms — elevated credibility, not just efficiency
- Process-level AI integration that their organisation can see, trust, and scale
- Stakeholder-friendly dashboards: *"better conversations towards enhancement, continuous improvement"*
- Time savings redirected to genuinely higher-value work — not just faster versions of the same work
- A peer cohort operating at the same level — not beginners, not theorists

Comforts

- Manual validation layer — never direct copy-paste, always a review step: *"you need to look at it and go, really? That doesn't make sense"*
- Own content first, then AI as verification (*"eigen content eerst, dan AI als verificatie/check"*)
- Iterative improvement discipline — never accepting first AI output, always second and third passes
- Critical thinking as the quality control mechanism

Anxieties

- Being replaced — by AI itself or by colleagues who use it more fluently: *"Feel competent. Not feel replaced."*
- Loss of authenticity at scale: *"het is niet authentiek... als ik dat ga doen, dan heb ik het idee dat wat ik heb gemaakt niet meer voor mij is"* (if I do that, I feel like what I made is no longer mine)
- AI perpetuating debunked learning science (learning styles etc.) — undermines professional credibility if they use it uncritically
- Cognitive dependency developing without noticing: the addiction dynamic
- Compliance exposure from working around restrictions — *"I don't want to pirate"*
- The gap between where they are personally and where their organisation is becoming unbridgeable

🔑 What This Persona Needs from the AI Sandbox

The sandbox must:

- Provide a **peer cohort at the same level** — not a beginner cohort. This persona needs to stop working alone and find others who have crossed the personal-use threshold and are facing the same organisational

ceiling

- Give them **workflow redesign frames**, not prompting tips — they already know how to prompt. What they need is a way to think about which processes to redesign and how to make that legible to their organisation
- Surface the **echo chamber problem** explicitly — the Override Log, and peer interrogation of override reasoning, directly addresses their isolation. They need someone to ask *"why did you make that decision?"* and mean it
- Help them **build the language** to bring their organisation along — slides, templates, stakeholder narratives that translate what they've built personally into something others can trust and approve
- Offer a **Copilot-compatible track** that doesn't make them feel like a second-class participant while also honouring what they've built on more capable tools
- Name the **identity shift** explicitly: from content producer to workflow designer to strategic partner. They are stuck at the threshold not for lack of skill but for lack of a frame and a community to cross it with

If the sandbox is a beginner space, they leave. If it's a tool showcase, they leave. What keeps them is a cohort of peers at the threshold — and a programme that names the leap they're trying to make.